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PROGRAMMING JARGON



In the XKCD comic “Up Goer Five” (<https://xkcd.com/1133/>), the webcomic’s artist Randall Munroe created a technical schematic for the Saturn V rocket using only the 1,000 most common English words. The comic breaks down all the technical jargon into sentences a young child could understand. But it also highlights why we can’t explain everything using simple terms: The explanation “Thing to help people escape really fast if there’s a problem and everything is on fire so they decide not to go to space” might be easier to understand for a lay audience than “Launch Escape System.” But it’s too verbose for NASA engineers to say in their day-to-day work. Even then, they’d probably rather use the acronym LES.